

The Pedals of Persistence

A journey defined not by the speed of the sprint, but by the persistence of the pedal.

The Roots: Manikganj and the Bicycle

It's funny how we spend our whole lives trying to "get somewhere," only to realize the best parts of us are still stuck in the places we left behind. Growing up in a middle-class Muslim home in Manikganj, love wasn't something we talked about in big, dramatic ways—it was just there, in the quiet discipline and the way we showed up for each other. Manikganj Government High School was the architect of everything I am. Back then, life felt so clear, unburdened by the "weight" of the world. My most prized possession was this old, rusted black bicycle. It was basically a skeletal frame held together by hope, but to me, it was a literal set of wings. I wasn't just pedaling to school; I was pedaling toward a version of myself I hadn't even met yet.

The Shift: The Dhaka Crucible

I wouldn't have the clarity I have now if it weren't for the "Dhaka chapter."



Nafiz Iqbal Borshon | An economist in the making—saving time by assuming I'm always right.

Moving there in 2021 for Notre Dame College was a massive culture shock. It was a definitive departure from the familiar, as I traded the quiet of home for the dynamic energy of the city. The streets of Dhaka became my laboratory, and those historic campus walls were where I actually grew up. I had to learn how to balance the pressure of grades with the reality of being responsible for myself. It was a grind, but it turned my abstract dreams into actual goals—it was the moment I started navigating the world with a real sense of purpose.

My Future Aspirations:

- *Global Travel: Exploring the world and experiencing diverse cultures.*
- *Economic Research: Conducting advanced research on global economic issues.*
- *BCS Cadre: Serving the nation through administrative leadership.*

The Vision: Economics and the Long Run

Now, that kid on the bicycle has evolved into a CU economics student, realizing that his "Royal Subject" is the invisible thread connecting the world's prosperity. My life is now a marathon toward national impact, fueled by the same persistence that once powered those pedals. Though the challenges of maturity loom, I remain fixed on the horizon, pedaling toward a sustainable future with the spirit of that boy on the black bike.